

SECOND WAVE

Many undead fall, yet more pour in through the breach. An anguished, unearthly chorus of shrieks is heard from above. Swooping down into the battle is a spectral humanoid figure draped in tattered rags and dangling iron chains. The shrieking emits from large gaping mouths all over its body that glow an intense bright blue.

A **shriekgeist** ([PICTURE](#)), statued as a **specter** (MM 279), has been lured to the ensuing carnage like a moth to a flame. It attacks the adventurers with incomprehensible hatred.

2 zombies and **2 skeletons** also join the battle using the same tactics as above.

If you are using Influence Dice, remove one of the Enemy Dice after the party defeats the second wave.

THIRD WAVE

A low, booming roar is heard from the wall, followed by shouts of surprise and despair as a hulking stitched abomination heaves itself through the breach. It swings morningstar down at the nearest cathar, slamming the poor human deep into the earth with a sickening crunch and a spatter of blood. More zombies squeeze through as the skaab moves forward.

2 zombies, 1 skeleton, and 1 skaab goliath (APPENDIX B) ([PICTURE](#)). Same tactics as above.

DEVELOPMENTS

If the adventurers defeat all three waves, the cathars destroy the remaining undead and have enough time to seal up the breach with a makeshift barricade of wood and stone debris. It's not very strong, but it's enough to deter the undead from entering through here.

If the adventurers retreat from the battle instead, then the position is quickly overrun by undead. While many more zombies enter through the breach, all is not lost, since the horde as a whole isn't organized enough to take full advantage of this entrance and send more numbers through. Any surviving cathars retreat back to the gate to inform Captain Levi of the situation, which he responds to by leading a group of his best soldiers to launch a counterattack and reclaim the area.

RESULTS

The location of the next encounter, "Necromancer Confrontation," depends on the adventurer's previous actions:

- If both the gate and the breach were successfully defended, a frustrated Rinelda scales the wall and makes a last-ditch attempt to defeat the defenders

with her remaining forces.

- If either the gate or wall breach was lost, then Rinelda enters through that location with her remaining forces.
- If both the gates and the wall breach were lost, then the undead overrun the outer defenses. The defenders are routed, and a messenger comes to the adventurers telling them to regroup at the chapel. The adventurers have enough time for a short rest before an overconfident Rinelda leads the final assault against the chapel, calling out any champions to face her.

NECROMANCER CONFRONTATION

A messenger arrives from Captain Levi, requiring the party's immediate assistance: a necromancer has arrived and is cutting through his troops. The adventurers are needed to stop her onslaught.

When the characters arrive, dozens of defenders and zombies are locked in battle. Rinelda Smitt stands out amongst the crowd, squaring off with Captain Levi. The cathar commander, statued as a **thug** (MM 350; Lawful Good), is barely hanging in there -- he's down to 10 hit points and suffering from 1 level of exhaustion. Rinelda is toying with him using her *spiritual weapon* (in the form of a spectral dagger) to stab at him.

If you want to use Influence Dice in this battle, represent the defenders fighting here with two Ally Dice, and the undead two Enemy Dice.

Rinelda Smitt (APPENDIX B) ([PICTURE](#)) travels with **3 zombies** (MM 316) that she uses as her personal bodyguards. If attacked, she'll use her reaction to shove a zombie in front of the blow if possible. Rinelda prefers to fight at range, casting *hold person* and *sacred flames* as appropriate while swinging with her *spiritual weapon* spell.

The necromancer has a terrible temper and delusions of immortality, considering how well she's survived all her life so far. She can be coaxed into fighting recklessly, and if pressed into melee, she casts *inflict wounds*.

DEVELOPMENTS

Rinelda Smitt is insane. The teen lost her parents at a very young age and has survived in the wilderness purely off her talents in necromancy. She is devoid of empathy for her victims, seeing humans as useful only as resources to raid for food, clothing, shelter, and their corpses for undead. She offers no remorse because such a feeling is alien to her.

The only thing Rinelda understands and respects is power. If her life is on the line, she'll explain her partnership with Siegfried, and how she's culling the land to bring him



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corpses for his experiments (see “The Horde’s Purpose”). Rinelda respects Siegfried’s talents and hopes to learn everything she can as his apprentice before inevitably murdering him and taking over his residence.

Rinelda carries basic necessities (clothing, food) along with a *ghoulcaller’s bell* (APPENDIX A) (PICTURE), and a large pouch containing 5 ep and 92 gp. On her person is a note written by Siegfried, reminding the teen to collect everything she can find in his shop’s basement, from papers to alchemical supplies.

VICTORY!

With Rinelda defeated, the undead briefly falter, looking dazed. A loud cheer erupts from nearby defenders as they see the adventurer’s victory. The people fight fiercer with renewed resolve, pushing back the horde and eventually vanquishing them. It takes another two hours to clean up any undead roaming within the town’s walls.

How well the defenders fared depends on the adventurer’s accomplishments. If both the gate and wall breach held, then casualties and property damage are shockingly few. The more failed objectives, the worse the death toll and damage to Shadowgrange.

The townsfolk spend the next day carrying out post-battle activities: clergy members tend to the wounded, cathars dismantle barricades, tradesfolk begin repairing damages, and other people help with gathering the dead to be buried later.

A group of cathars rides out to cleanse the surrounding valley of any pockets of undead still roaming the land. The few scattered zombies are easily disposed of. When the cathars return, they bring news that some of the zombies were guarding large wooden wagons, some empty and others holding corpses.

Once all the immediate concerns are taken care of, Priestess Flora invites the characters to a great victory celebration. The celebration begins with a rousing speech by Flora in front of the chapel, where she publicly thanks the characters each by name. Take the time to play this scene

out, and make sure to call out a couple of key actions of bravery or even luck that each character displayed during the battle. Without the party’s help, hundreds of people would now be dead and Shadowgrange would have been lost.

At the end of the speech, Flora motions to bring forth a large chest filled with coins to be given to the adventurers as thanks. Assuming the characters succeeded on each objective, the chest contains 2,100 cp, 1,050 sp, and 260 gp. Reduce the amount of coins depending on how many objectives were failed, as the town will need more money to repair damages incurred in the battle.

After the chest is presented and the crowd finishes cheering for the adventurers, Eckhardt approaches them and asks for a word in private. When they move somewhere more quiet, the innkeeper solemnly gifts the party two of the best items from the cathars’ armory. If Captain Levi fell in battle, these are his personal items, and Eckhardt explains that the deceased cathar would be honored if his arms continued to slay the wicked. The gifts are a *+1 weapon* and *+1 armor/shield*. Customize the weapon and armor to your party: for example, if a Dexterity-focused rogue still needs a weapon and prefers using a rapier, perhaps the weapon is a *+1 rapier* called Kindness; its handguard decorated in silver filigree in the shape of a thousand feathers; it glows pale blue in the presence of fiends.

DEFEAT!

If the characters failed to defeat Rinelda but succeeded in either holding the gate or the wall breach, then the necromancer forces the defenders to retreat to the chapel while the horde overruns the rest of Shadowgrange. Here the adventurers have enough time for a short rest before Rinelda gathers her forces for a final assault. This is the final chance to stop the undead and save the town.

If the adventurers fail to stop Rinelda at the chapel, then the defenders are broken. Priestess Flora and the rest of the surviving council members rallies what’s left of the townsfolk for one desperate push, fighting their way out of Shadowgrange. They take heavy losses doing so, but eventually the survivors make it out alive. The undead horde is too disorganized to give chase.

Priestess Flora contacts the characters and thanks them for their aid, but she is unable to hide the bitterness and despair in her voice. There is no ceremony, and this meeting is rushed. Shadowgrange is lost, and its people flee south to neighboring communities as refugees. Word of the horde’s rampage travels to Silbern (see “Evacuation”) and perhaps the cathars there mobilize enough troops to stop the horde. Or maybe the vampire families step in, destroying the undead to protect their

human livestock.

DEVELOPMENTS

After the adventurers have a bit of time to recover from the battle, Priestess Flora contacts them. She explains that her people have never encountered an undead horde like the one they faced. Flora knows that the stitched horrors, the skaabs, are the foul work of necro-alchemists. If the army was built by such people, it may be that the horde they encountered is but a precursor to more attacks to come. For the sake of all Stensia, Flora begs the adventurers to find the source of these undead and stop it once and for all. The refugees from Mordov said that the horde came from the north, and the most notable location north of there is Mauer Estate, a long-abandoned mansion that has housed many residents over the centuries, from ancient royalty to mad wizards.

If the adventurers mention Siegfried, either their findings in his alchemy shop or the note on Rinelda Smitt, then Priestess Flora agrees that he could be the source. Siegfried was last seen heading in the direction of Mauer Estate, and if they have evidence that he turned to necro-alchemy, then it seems like he would be the first one the adventurers should confront.

AWARDING EXPERIENCE POINTS

Divide 2,000 XP equally among the characters if the party helps save the townsfolk from the undead horde.

If the undead horde is defeated, award another 4,800 XP equally among the characters.

CONCLUSION OF PART 3

Part 3 begins once the adventurers decide to head north to Mauer Estate, where Siegfried works tirelessly to create even more fearsome threats.

MILESTONE: LEVEL 4!

If you are using Milestone Experience, then the characters attain 4th level after the horde has been dealt with.



PART 4: INTO THE FARBOG

In this part of the adventure, the characters travel to Mauer Estate, located at the northern edge of Stensia's outer valley. To do so, they will need to journey through a large bog that divides the southern part of the valley from its northern tip.

Depending on which NPCs the characters met and which quests or clues they picked up, some or all the following information might be known to them:

- Priestess Flora wants the characters to travel to Mauer Estate and uncover the source of the undead.
- Rinelda Smit can confirm that Siegfried is the creator of the undead armies and is working at Mauer Estate.
- Silvia Wintsch wants the characters to bring her any sanguine lotus they find in the bog.
- Siegfried holds the missing piece of the Strionic Resonator, which some of the characters may have been tasked to retrieve for the Church of Avacyn.

FARBOG SUPERSTITIONS

If the characters agree to Priestess Flora's request to check out Mauer Estate, she thanks them for their courage and commitment to righteousness. Flora warns them to be careful while traversing the farbog (Innistrad's fancy term for bog/swamp) that the adventurers must pass through to reach the estate. In particular, she warns them about hellhounds: "I know you're strong and capable adventurers, but trust me, if you come across a hellhound... run." This warning is particularly important to give the characters, as it sets up the "Hounds of Baskerville" encounter.

Once the characters accept Flora's mission, word spreads around town of the character's impending journey through the farbog (Flora tells her clergymen, they tell friends and relatives, and it spreads). Helpful, but superstitious townsfolk approach the party members and offer advice on how to stay safe. The suggestions range from reasonably insightful to ignorance. Some suggestions include:

- Never stare into a hellhound's eyes or it will devour your soul.
- Eat wormwood and other bitter herbs; it will make

you less palatable to things that roam the night (the townsfolk that suggests it offers the character some of the aforementioned herb).

- Travel by day and rest at roadside shrines by night.
- If you hear howling at midnight, someone close to you will die.
- Be quiet while traversing the ancient grafs (Innistrad's fancy term for "crypt") inside the farbog, lest you wake the dead.
- Pale ghosts are the friendly kind, except when they're not.
- Travel by night and rest at roadside shrines by day.
- If a black cat crosses the road in front of you, it's a sign of bad luck.

If the characters ask about the farbog itself, they can find out from various townsfolk that it's a treacherous swamp that people avoid if possible. One prominent rumor is that the farbog used to be a beautiful forest with one of the most influential settlements in all of Innistrad, but an evil tainted the forest, turning it into the farbog it is now.

The bog has a well-known reputation for being the residence of hellhounds, though it's also said that few folk are lucky enough to see one and live to tell the tale. Others mention that ancient grafs dissolve into the muck, causing the restless dead to stir as geists (spirits) and ghouls.

TRAVELING TO THE SWAMP

It takes one day of traveling north through the outer valley to reach the farbog. A few abandoned communities can be found in between Shadowgrange and the bog; the undead horde passed through these settlements on their way to Shadowgrange, killing most of the inhabitants and sending their corpses back to Mauer Estate. None of these communities are remarkable: each is comprised of outlying farms and cabins huddled together, with a modest chapel for prayer. If you wish, you can place one of these villages in the path of the characters, offering the opportunity to explore the wreckage. Perhaps a few people managed to survive the undead's rampage and still live here. Or maybe some undead still linger in the area, hungering for the living.

The zombie horde left Mauer Estate and trekked south, through the farbog, through the small villages, all the way to Shadowgrange. Their footprints are easy to spot and follow back to the estate. In addition to footprints, heavy wagon wheels can be followed. These wagons were carried by the horde and filled with corpses. Once filled, the wagon would be hauled back to Mauer Estate, where Siegfried would use them in his experiments.

THE FARBOG

Once the adventurers enter the farbog, read or paraphrase: *The grassy plains of the valley dampens into inky black muck as you enter the farbog. Barren pine trees sink into the mud at odd angles, creating a tangle of dead trunks. A dreary grey mist envelopes the area.*

The farbog is muddy, damp, and stinks of rotting vegetation. A mist surrounds the area; it doesn't impede nearby vision, but anything beyond 300 feet disappears behind the grey curtain.

The ground is a mix of muddy earth and shallow bog. Traveling through here is considered difficult terrain (see the rulebook for more information). The zombie horde mostly stuck to the main road that passes through the swamp; adventurers following the main road or zombie horde can easily track hundreds of shambling footprints and heavy wagon wheels dragged through the muck.

Following the main road, which runs north to south, is the easiest way to journey through the swamp towards Mauer Estate.

SWAMP ENCOUNTERS

Traveling through the swamp takes one day. Along the journey through the farbog, the characters will partake in three of the following events below (though feel free to run as many events as you wish!).

Choose three of the events, marking when they occur (day/night). Alternatively, roll a D6 and consult the Swamp Encounters table to determine what the party meets, rerolling any 6 or duplicate results.

The difficulty of combat encounters and their subsequent XP awards assume a party of four level 4's. If this is not the case in your game, or if you wish to make the combat easier or harder, you may tweak the combat encounters to your desired difficulty with [Kobold Fight Club](#) or similar builders.

d8	Event
1	The Hounds of Baskerville
2	Whispers of Hope and Doom
3	Deadly Lotus
4	Little Girl's Plea
5	Corpse Wagons

THE HOUNDS OF BASKERVILLE

This encounter works best if the characters have been

previously warned about hellhounds in the swamp (See “Farbog Superstitions”).

As the characters journey through the swamp, they pass by the sunken remains of a long-forgotten village called Baskerville. What little remains of the crumbling and sunken village structures is barely recognizable in the overgrowth and muck. The skeletal remains of many of the villagers can be found littered around the area. A Wisdom (Medicine) DC 12 reveals none of them died from physical violence. A Wisdom (Insight) DC 15 check indicates that the people appear to have all died in a state of absolute terror.

The area filled with gloomgas mushrooms. These mushrooms release spores with hallucinogenic properties as the characters pass through. The spores fill the air and mixes invisibly with the surrounding fog.

The gloomgas mushrooms grow at the base of the surrounding pine trees, blending perfectly with the bark. The spore clouds are released with a low rumbling sound

that echoes throughout the area and is almost impossible to pinpoint its origins. Characters can spot one of these mushrooms with a DC 25 Perception check. A Nature DC 20 can identify a spotted gloomgas mushroom.

Every round that a character is exposed to the spores, they must make a DC 15 Constitution check or be poisoned by the spore’s hallucinogenic properties. Characters that don’t breathe or are immune to poison are unaffected. Since the characters traveling through this part of the swamp are likely exposed to the spores for minutes or longer, it can be assumed that anyone not immune is eventually poisoned.

A poisoned character gradually begins to hallucinate. Read or paraphrase for them:

The fog grows cloyingly thick and surrounds you utterly. The pine trees seem taller here, leaning over you as if to snatch you with gnarled, claw-like branches. The muck you trek through sucks down your foot more with each



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